

Hyunjong Ok

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Research Interests

I develop evaluation methods for **multimodal and speech-enabled language models**. My work focuses on **diagnostic benchmark design**, auditory and temporal grounding, full-duplex voice-agent evaluation, and **data-efficient evaluation and inference** that preserve model-ranking fidelity at lower cost.

Keywords: multimodal and speech LLMs, benchmark design, full-duplex interaction, efficient evaluation

Research and Industry Experience

AI Research Engineer Intern

Dec. 2025 – May 2026

Upstage

- Developed data-efficient VLM evaluation methods that preserve model rankings while substantially reducing benchmark scale, by analyzing benchmark redundancy, item informativeness, and cross-model generalization across large VLM evaluation suites.

AI Research Engineer Intern

Mar. 2023 – Sep. 2023

Naver Cloud

- Conducted research on knowledge-enhanced multimodal named entity recognition (SCANNER, NAACL 2024) and implemented OCR post-processing components for document-AI pipelines.

Selected Scholarships

Ph.D. Excellence Scholarship (Science and Engineering)

Jun. 2026

Korea Student Aid Foundation

Publications

*Equal contribution.

TempCore: Are Video QA Benchmarks Temporally Grounded? A Frame Selection Sensitivity Analysis and Benchmark

[\[Paper\]](#)

Hyunjong Ok, Jaeho Lee

Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP), 2026

Speculative End-Turn Detector for Efficient Speech Chatbot Assistant

[\[Paper\]](#)

Hyunjong Ok, Suho Yoo, Jaeho Lee

The 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL), 2026

Lost in the Prompt Order: Revealing the Limitations of Causal Attention in Language Models

[\[Paper\]](#)

Hyunjong Ok, Jaeho Lee

Findings of the 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL Findings), 2026

AuditoryBench++: Can Language Models Understand Auditory Knowledge without Hearing?

[\[Paper\]](#)

Hyunjong Ok*, Suho Yoo*, Hyeonjun Kim, Jaeho Lee

IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech, and Signal Processing (ICASSP, Oral), 2026

S2Cap: A Benchmark and a Baseline for Singing Style Captioning

[\[Paper\]](#)

Hyunjong Ok, Jaeho Lee

ACM International Conference on Information and Knowledge Management (CIKM, Resource Paper), 2025

Imagine to Hear: Auditory Knowledge Generation Can Be an Effective Assistant for Language Models

[\[Paper\]](#)

Suho Yoo*, Hyunjong Ok*, Jaeho Lee

Findings of the 63rd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL Findings), 2025

AudioBERT: Audio Knowledge Augmented Language Model
Hyunjong Ok*, Suho Yoo*, Jaeho Lee
IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech, and Signal Processing (**ICASSP**), 2025

[Paper]

Decoding with Limited Teacher Supervision Requires Understanding When to Trust the Teacher
Hyunjong Ok, Jegwang Ryu, Jaeho Lee
Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (**EMNLP**), 2024

[Paper]

SCANNER: Knowledge-Enhanced Approach for Robust Multi-modal Named Entity Recognition of Unseen Entities
Hyunjong Ok, Taeho Kil, Sukmin Seo, Jaeho Lee
Conference of the North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (**NAACL**), 2024

[Paper]

Post-Trained Language Model Adaptive to Extractive Summarization of Long Spoken Documents
Hyunjong Ok, Seong-Bae Park
IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech, and Signal Processing (**ICASSP** Grand Challenge), 2023

[Paper]

Understanding the Effects of Distractors on Reasoning Vision-Language Models
Jiyun Bae, **Hyunjong Ok**, Sangwoo Mo, Jaeho Lee
Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (**EMNLP**), 2026

[Paper]

[Preprints]
OmniKVQuant: KV Cache Quantization for Omni-LLMs
Suho Yoo*, **Hyunjong Ok***, Jongmin Choi, Jihoo Jung, Joon Son Chung
arXiv preprint arXiv:2609.11582, 2026

[Paper]

[Workshops]
FinTree: Financial Dataset Pretrain Transformer Encoder for Relation Extraction
Hyunjong Ok
Workshop on Knowledge Discovery from Unstructured Data in Financial Services (**SIGIR Workshop**), 2023

[Paper]

Education

POSTECH Integrated M.S./Ph.D. Program, Graduate School of Artificial Intelligence Advisor: Prof. Jaeho Lee	Feb. 2024 – Present Expected Aug. 2027
Kyung Hee University B.S. in Software Convergence, Data Science	Feb. 2019 – Aug. 2023

Selected Awards

International	
ICASSP 2023 MUG Grand Challenge, Track 2: Extractive Text Summarization Alibaba Cloud	1st Place Feb. 2023
SIGIR 2023 KDF Workshop Shared Task: Relation Extraction J.P. Morgan AI Research	2nd Place Jun. 2023
Kaggle Two Silver medals, one Bronze medal	Competitions Expert 2022
Domestic	
The 12th Conference of the Korean Artificial Intelligence Association (CKAIA)	Outstanding Paper Aug. 2025
The 11th Joint Conference of the Korean Artificial Intelligence Association (JKAIA)	Outstanding Paper Nov. 2024
National Defense AI Challenge Korea Ministry of National Defense	4th Place Dec. 2023

Korean AI Challenge: ASR Track <i>Korea Ministry of Science and ICT</i>	4th Place <i>Nov. 2023</i>
Korean AI Challenge: ASR Track (Minister's Award) <i>Korea Ministry of Science and ICT</i>	1st Place <i>Oct. 2022</i>
Legal Judgment Prediction Challenge: Text Classification <i>Law & Company</i>	1st Place <i>Dec. 2022</i>
Genome EC Number Classification AI Challenge <i>Infoboss</i>	2nd Place <i>Dec. 2022</i>
Sentence Type Classification AI Challenge <i>Sungkyunkwan University</i>	4th Place <i>Dec. 2022</i>

Mentoring

Suho Yoo, M.S. Student at KAIST *Aug. 2024 – Sep. 2025*
 Research mentoring leading to publications at ICASSP 2025 and ACL Findings 2025

Academic Service

Conference Reviewer: ACL Rolling Review (ARR), NeurIPS, CIKM

Technical Skills

Programming: Python

Frameworks and Tools: PyTorch, Hugging Face, Docker, Linux, Git, Slurm